

IDIOMS AND PHRASES

COMPLETE EXERCISE

Directions (Q. Nos. 1-18) *In each of the following questions an idiomatic phrase is given followed by four alternatives. Choose the alternative that best expresses the meaning of the expression.*

1. At one's wits end
(a) perplexed (b) explain
(c) clear up (d) enlighten
2. Hang together
(a) confirm each other
(b) live together
(c) hang with each other
(d) go together
3. Hard boiled
(a) boiled hard (b) extremely hot
(c) hardened (d) hardly boiled
4. Get cold feet
(a) to run for life
(b) to get cold
(c) to be afraid
(d) to become discourteous
5. Make no bones about
(a) to make no effort
(b) to admit something readily
(c) to make fuss about
(d) to create hindrance
6. Turn out crabs
(a) end in failure
(b) to be successful
(c) to bring up crabs
(d) to be victorious
7. Devil's advocate
(a) an advocate of a Devil
(b) an advocate like a Devil
(c) discussion of an Advocate
(d) holding a opinion against religion
8. Between the devil and the sea
(a) in a fix
(b) a Devil in the sea
(c) in a worse situation
(d) a compromising situation
9. Dance attendance on
(a) to flatter
(b) to dance with a partner
(c) to attend upon
(d) to attend to
10. Go a-begging
(a) to remain unused
(b) go for begging
(c) beg for going
(d) request for something
11. A gala day
(a) a day of success
(b) a day of merry-making
(c) an eventful day
(d) a day of significance
12. Go hot and cold
(a) get angry
(b) get irritated
(c) get out of cold
(d) sudden feeling of fear and anxiety
13. Gird up one's lions
(a) get ready for a job
(b) leave bag and baggage
(c) hunt for lions
(d) a lion cloth
14. Pocket an insult
(a) bear insult without protest
(b) not to take any action
(c) sit over a resolution
(d) ignore a case
15. At daggers drawn
(a) real cause (b) to be puzzled
(c) at enmity (d) at friendship
16. Blow by blow
(a) Eruptions in quick succession from a great volcano
(b) Continuously raining with thunders
(c) Describe an event as it occurred in every detail
(d) A rapid decline of business leading to its closure
17. By hook or by crook
(a) In a completely insane manner
(b) In whatever way one can
(c) Being very evil and destructive
(d) To be very tenacious
18. Chock-a-block
(a) Filled to capacity
(b) Not being able to fulfil one's desires
(c) Blocking somebody's path to progress
(d) Suffocation caused due to living in a congested area

Directions (Q. Nos. 19-30) *In the below given questions a word or a phrase has been underlined in the sentences. Four alternative meaning of the same are given in the option (a), (b), (c) and (d). Choose the option which is closest in meaning to the underlined word or phrase.*

19. The boy turned a deaf ear to the pleadings of all his well-wishers.
(a) listened carefully
(b) was deadly opposed
(c) posed indifference
(d) did not pay any attention
20. We should give a wide berth to bad character.
(a) keep away from
(b) publical condemn
(c) give publicity to
(d) not sympathise with
21. Sumit had to look high and low before he could find his scooter key.
(a) nowhere (b) always
(c) everywhere (d) somewhere
22. At a party, he is always in high spirits.
(a) talkative
(b) cheerful
(c) drunk
(d) uncontrollable
23. She rejected his proposal of marriage point blank.
(a) completely (b) pointedly
(c) absurdly (d) briefly
24. We should guard against our green-eyed friends.
(a) rich (b) jealous
(c) handsome (d) enthusiastic
25. Rahul fought tooth and nail to save his company.
(a) with weapons
(b) as best as he could
(c) using unfair means
(d) with all one's energy
26. The popularity of the yester year's superstar is on the wane.
(a) growing more
(b) at its peak
(c) growing less
(d) at rock bottom
27. The sight of the accident made my flesh creep.
(a) worried me
(b) frightened me
(c) confused me
(d) drew my attention

30. The doctor says that the patient has turned the corner.
- (a) completely recover
 - (b) become worse
 - (c) passed the crisis
 - (d) died

10. It needs an expert to decipher the secret message sent to the Army Officers during war time.
(a) swindle (b) decode
(c) make up (d) defy
11. Bana in Sanskrit, Lyly in English and Prasad in Hindi are celebrated for their florid style.
(a) ornate (b) rich
(c) refined (d) rambling
12. My brother's zest for the new project was infectious.
(a) greed (b) enthusiasm
(c) attraction (d) fascination
13. The eyewitness testimony was incontrovertible.
(a) disputable (b) debatable
(c) unacceptable (d) unquestionable
14. His forthright behaviour shows that he is honest but he seems rude to some people.
(a) courteous (b) straightforward
(c) tactful (d) correct
15. The minister's speech was comprehensive and was greatly appreciated.
(a) praiseworthy
(b) full of fine words
(c) covering all aspects
(d) understandable

[illegible]



EXPLANATIONS

Complete Exercise

1. (a) At one's wits end means to be so upset that you do not know what to do. So, 'perplexed' is its right meaning.
2. (a) Hang together means to support or help one another. So, 'confirm each other' is its right meaning.
3. (c) Hard boiled means not showing much emotion, i.e. 'hardened'.
4. (c) Get cold feet means to suddenly become too frightened to do something you had planned to do. So, 'to be afraid' is its right meaning.
5. (b) Make no bones about means to be honest and open about something. So, option (b) is correct.
6. (a) Turn out crabs means 'to end in failure'.
7. (d) Devil's advocate is a person 'who expresses an opinion that do not really hold or is against religion'.
8. (a) Between the devil and the sea means 'to be in a difficult situation or in a fix'.
9. (d) Dance attendance on means 'to attend to someone'.
10. (a) 'To become or remain unused', unclaimed, unfilled or unwanted, especially a job or product.
11. (b) A gala day means 'a day of merry making or a festive occasion'.
12. (d) Go hot and cold means 'to experience a sudden feeling of fear and anxiety'.
13. (a) Gird up one's lions means to prepare oneself for something requiring strength or endurance. So, option (a) is correct.
14. (a) Pocket an insult means 'to bear insult without any objection'.
15. (c) At daggers drawn means 'extreme unfriendliness, i.e. enmity'.
16. (c) Blow by blow means 'to describe an event as it occurred in every detail'.
17. (b) By hook or by crook means 'in whatever way one can'.
18. (a) Chock-a-block means 'very full of things or people'.
19. (d) Deaf ear means 'not to pay any attention'.
20. (a) Wide berth means 'to keep distance from something or somebody'.
21. (c) High and low means 'everywhere'.
22. (b) High spirits means 'cheerful'.
23. (a) Point blank means 'completely and will not change your decision'.
24. (b) Green-eyed means 'envious or jealous'.
25. (d) Tooth and nail means 'with full strength and fury'.
26. (c) On the wane means 'growing less or to become weak'.
27. (b) Flesh creep means 'to get frightened'.
28. (c) Queer fish means 'very strange person'.
29. (b) On my nerves means 'to irritate someone'.
30. (c) Turned the corner means 'to pass the difficult situation or crisis and begin to improve'.

Questions from CDS Exam (2013)

1. (b) Disdain means 'to refuse to do something, because you think that you are too important to do it'.
2. (c) Evocative means 'something that makes you think of or remember a strong image or feeling'.
3. (d) Expeditious means 'prompt and efficient'.
4. (c) Flippant means 'showing that you don't take something seriously'. So, option (c) is correct.
5. (a) Impromptu means 'without preparation'.
6. (d) Monotonous means 'never changing and therefore, repetitive and boring'.
7. (b) Redundant means 'not needed or useful'.
8. (d) Look up means 'improve'.
9. (b) Infirmity means 'weakness'.
10. (b) Decipher means 'to find the meaning of something that is difficult to read or understand'.
11. (d) Florid here means having too much detail. 'Rambling' means 'very long'.
12. (b) Zest means 'enthusiasm'.
13. (d) Incontrovertible means 'not able to be denied or disputed'.
14. (b) Forthright means 'direct and honest in manner'.
15. (c) Comprehensive means 'including all or almost all that may be concerned'.

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SENTENCE COMPLETION

Generally, 10 to 15 questions based on sentence completion are asked in CDS exam. The question can be based on a sentence or paragraph format. The candidate has to choose to fill the blank from the given options.



Sentence completion comprises of filling up of the gaps given in a particular sentence individually or in a passage. The sentence has a blank and is followed by four options. A candidate has to pick the correct option to fill the blank in order to make the sentence meaningful and grammatically correct.

A candidate should read the given sentence first and try to deduce the meaning of the statement. After that, the inferred meaning should be matched with the given options. The closest inferential word is to be selected as the choice.

Language Skills Required for Sentence Completion

Sentence completion becomes a great ease when a student is well-versed in these areas of languages

- Using correct adjective forms
- Words followed by prepositions
- Idioms, phrases and phrasal verbs
- Noun and its forms
- Using the correct verb form

Apart from all these, a good command over vocabulary also helps a candidate in solving questions on Sentence Completion correctly.



SENTENCE COMPLETION EXERCISE

SET 1 SINGLE SENTENCE COMPLETION

Directions (Q.Nos. 1-57) *Pick out the most effective word from the given words to fill in the blank to make the sentence **meaningfully** complete.*

1. The two sisters look so that it is difficult to tell one from the other.
(a) same (b) similar
(c) identical (d) alike
2. Since one cannot read every book, one should be content with making a selection.
(a) normal (b) standard
(c) sample (d) judicious
3. Success comes to those, who are vigilant not to permit from the chosen path.
(a) diversion (b) deviation
(c) obstruction (d) alienation
4. His actions had pain and suffering on thousands of people.
(a) deplored (b) eliminated
(c) affected (d) inflicted
5. He has good over the famous world languages.
(a) authority (b) expertise
(c) hold (d) command
6. The lions in the Gir forest are protected as they come under species.
(a) dangerous (b) engendered
(c) enamoured (d) endangered
7. People, who have an reputation are often avoided by the rest.
(a) unsteady (b) unsavory
(c) unsafe (d) unsatisfied
8. My father was too to push open the heavy door.
(a) timid (b) faint
(c) feeble (d) faltering
9. He does not suffer from any disease at all.
(a) acute (b) chronic
(c) temporary (d) irregular
10. We are not sure, if their business is strictly
(a) prudent (b) honest
(c) judicious (d) legitimate
11. The claims made by the manufacturer of the product are so extravagant that only the will accept them on face value.
(a) cynical (b) gullible
(c) rich (d) indifferent
12. Justice should be even-handedly.
(a) discharged
(b) performed
(c) declared
(d) administered
13. The leader of the opposition party condemned the communal riots in terms.
(a) unambiguous
(b) unparliamentary
(c) unequivocal
(d) uncontrollable
14. They should spend less time about and more with their children.
(a) gallivanting (b) gravitating
(c) frisking (d) flirting
15. The government's handling of the situation led to violations of human rights.
(a) tumultuous (b) obvious
(c) ostensible (d) flagrant
16. A bullet his cheek.
(a) grazed (b) glazed
(c) grasped (d) screamed
17. The injured man was still groggy and could only give a account of the accident.
(a) garish (b) gangling
(c) garbled (d) garrulous
18. The teacher's counsel had a effect on the mischievous student's conduct.
(a) memorable (b) salutary
(c) sudden (d) forceful
19. The majority of village folk in India are illiterate and superstitious.
(a) overtly (b) delicately
(c) stubbornly (d) covertly
20. I must admit that my parents stood by me in my times of
(a) passion (b) duress
(c) involvement (d) criticism
21. Even, if it rains all day I will not be able to my journey.
(a) put by (b) put out
(c) put off (d) put away
22. Help yourself whatever you can use without wasting.
(a) with (b) to
(c) in (d) for
23. Indigenous products are now comparable imported goods in quality.
(a) against (b) to
(c) than (d) from
24. The Director pointed out in favour of the manager that the profitability of the plant had since he had taken over.
(a) added (b) arisen
(c) increased (d) declined
25. Madan the first prize in this competition.
(a) have won (b) win
(c) has won (d) is winning
26. In large cities, people are cut from nature.
(a) down (b) out
(c) off (d) away
27. As a general rule, politicians do not centre stage.
(a) foster (b) forbid
(c) forgive (d) forsake
28. We cannot go on strike every year. Now, that we have gone on strike we must this issue.
(a) canvass (b) cross
(c) clinch (d) culminate